

DHANVA TEACH Public Patient Guide

Hypertension Care & Dietary Guidelines

SECURITY BOUNDARY: PUBLIC - PATIENT ACCESSIBLE

Introduction to Hypertension Management

Hypertension, commonly known as high blood pressure, occurs when the force of blood pushing against the walls of your arteries is consistently elevated. Over time, untreated high blood pressure can lead to cardiovascular disease, stroke, and kidney failure. Managing your blood pressure is key to long-term health.

Nutritional Recommendations (DASH Diet)

The Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension (DASH) diet is highly recommended for lowering blood pressure. This eating plan focuses on consuming fruits, vegetables, whole grains, and lean proteins, such as poultry and fish. It strictly limits foods high in saturated fats, cholesterol, and refined sugars. Crucially, daily sodium intake should be reduced to under 1,500 milligrams to achieve the best therapeutic results.

Physical Activity and Lifestyle Habits

Engaging in regular aerobic physical activity, such as brisk walking, swimming, or cycling, for at least 150 minutes per week helps strengthen the cardiovascular system. Additionally, patients should avoid tobacco use, limit alcohol consumption, and practice stress-reduction techniques like meditation to maintain optimal vessel elasticity.

Home Blood Pressure Monitoring

Patients should monitor their blood pressure at home using a validated upper-arm cuff. Measurements should be taken at the same times each day, preferably in the morning before medication and in the evening. Keep a written log of your readings to share with your primary care provider during clinical consultations.